

## Chapter 48-1

Liang Shi immediately switched the video call to the background and opened the camera, capturing this girl named Guo Xinran in the last second before the TV screen changed.

At the bottom center of the screen was the girl's contact information.

If one were to say that Qiu Zimin had gradually aged over time, making it hard to see the resemblance between the two at first glance.

Then this girl and Liang Wanwan looked at least seventy percent alike.

Especially the nose and eyes, they were practically cast from the same mold.

Liang Shi stared at that string of numbers, hesitating for a long time, before finally just saving the photo.

She planned to think about it after she had eaten her fill.

Decisions made while hungry were easily impulsive.

Liang Shi switched the screen back to the video call. Xu Qingzhu hadn't hung up yet, just changed her angle.

Xu Qingzhu was sitting in her office chair, with a pile of blue folders in front of her. She casually picked one up, opened her fountain pen, quickly flipped through it, then signed her name on it.

When Liang Shi's face appeared on the screen again, she asked, "What were you doing just now?"

Liang Shi didn't mention Guo Xinran's matter and casually made up a lie, "Went to the bathroom."

Xu Qingzhu looked up slightly, those clear eyes casually glancing over, and Liang Shi immediately looked down at the food on the table.

Liang Shi didn't have much experience lying, and whenever she lied in front of Xu Qingzhu, she would become timid.

Right now she could only divert her attention.

Fortunately, Xu Qingzhu didn't say much more, only asking, "Can you still eat by yourself?"

Liang Shi: "Of course."

To prove the truth of her words, she even waved her arm, "Look, I'm saying... hiss..."

The wound seemed to be working against her.

With her large movement, a tearing pain came from her shoulder.

Xu Qingzhu panicked for a moment, then leaned back, nestling into her office chair. Her eyes and brows were full of amusement, with a hint of teasing: "What were you saying?"

Liang Shi: "..."

"I was saying I shouldn't be so cocky." Liang Shi picked up her chopsticks and propped her phone on the table.

The injury was to her left arm, so it didn't affect her eating.

The tearing pain from the wound just now still left her shaken, and she didn't dare to be cocky anymore.

"Good that you know." Xu Qingzhu continued working, "Eat your meal."

"Hey, what about you?" Liang Shi suddenly remembered, "Have you eaten?"

"I have." Xu Qingzhu gave a brief answer, then felt her response was too perfunctory, so she paused and added, "Cola chicken wings and steak."

"Alright." Liang Shi lowered her head to eat. Having a video call while eating was like live-streaming for someone, and even Liang Shi, who had plenty of camera experience, inevitably felt uncomfortable.

But when she needed to do business in the past, she would also live-stream at home, eating or chatting.

She wasn't a talent streamer, so her live-stream content was very monotonous—just chatting with fans.

It was quite awkward.

She got used to it later and would often pick questions from fan comments to answer.

Now she was live-streaming for just one person. Since Xu Qingzhu didn't say to hang up, she could only continue like this.

She ate much slower than usual at home.

## Chapter 48-2

Xu Qingzhu was handling documents, occasionally glancing at the screen.

After a while, Liang Shi asked, "How did you know I got injured?"

"The whole nation knows." Xu Qingzhu said, "You were trending on social media for half the day today. Are you happy?"

Liang Shi: "..."

What was there to be happy about!

She would rather not have this kind of trending topic.

She switched to the background to check Weibo, and sure enough, there was a trending topic #Dongheng Group Violent Elements#. Clicking on it showed a video of Liang Shi fiercely beating up that man.

Because there was strict control over sharp weapons now, the person who posted the video had censored the knife.

"..."

The video caption read: [Video sent by a friend. Have to say, this sister is very suitable for filming martial arts and crime dramas.]

She opened the comment section and found it was full of agreement.

[Too cool, sister, I'm available!]

[Are you sure this isn't filming? It looks better than current crime dramas. @Action film directors come and learn.]

[Does this sister have a boyfriend? If not, does she have Weibo?]

[Saved the CEO, now she can directly get promoted and reach the peak of life, right.]

[...]

The video only captured her profile, and because the action happened in a split second, it was impossible to capture her face clearly.

Everyone was frantically taking screenshots, but could only see her handsome silhouette.

"I've finished watching." Liang Shi felt mixed emotions and asked Xu Qingzhu, "Do you think this is a good thing?"

Xu Qingzhu's voice was very flat, "They didn't name names either. Your brother is already handling it, and the trending topic will be taken down soon."

Liang Shi had never worked at a big corporation before. Based on her past experience, it was usually easy for netizens to dig up information about someone they wanted to investigate.

Maybe it was because the circles she had been in had no secrets.

"The group has already sent internal emails to thoroughly investigate the source of the video." Xu Qingzhu said, "Don't worry, your brother won't push you out there. The trending topic was explosive this morning, but now the heat is rapidly declining."

Only then did Liang Shi feel somewhat relieved.

She didn't want to be known to netizens as the third young lady of the Liang family, otherwise when she debuted, her label would definitely be #Liang Family Fake Heiress#.

She wanted to enter the entertainment industry with a clean slate.

Then become a movie queen.

Her life goals were nothing more than this.

As for the mess of the Liang family, she would manage it if she could.

If Qiu Zimin decided to cut ties with her tomorrow, she would immediately drop everything and stop caring.

Whoever wanted to investigate could investigate.

Any more investigating on her part would just prove her stupidity.

Xu Qingzhu had a meeting at 1:30 PM and needed to prepare meeting materials, so after chatting with her for a few sentences, she hung up the video call.

Liang Shi looked and realized they had been on video for forty-eight minutes.

This was the first time this had happened to her.

In the past, when she was working, there might be group video conferences.

Or when a drama was about to air, she would do joint promotional work with others. Even when chatting, there would be a host to control the scene.

She was never the active one; all she could do was answer when asked.

But those were all facing many people. This kind of pure video chatting, or watching the other person eat and work, no matter how she thought about it, seemed to have some indescribable meaning.

It was too intimate.

But she liked this feeling in her heart.

And her mission also required this.

For her, it was a novel experience she had never had before.

Especially, Xu Qingzhu working seriously was very charming.

Lowered eyelids, serious expression, slender fingers gently brushing over papers—even though it was just a simple video call, it gave Liang Shi the comfortable feeling of watching a slow-paced movie.

It was the level of having her own built-in filter without any soft lighting.

## Chapter 48-3

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Liang Xinzhou had ordered too much food; there was no way to finish it all.

When injured, Liang Shi's appetite would decrease. She picked at some dishes but couldn't eat much more.

She took a short video of the leftover food and sent it to Liang Xinzhou, then wailed: [Big brother, really can't finish it all, such a waste.]

Liang Xinzhou quickly replied: [Someone will feed these to stray cats and dogs.]

Liang Shi still said: [Really don't need to order so much for me!]

Liang Xinzhou: [Okay.]

Liang Shi was surprised at how agreeable Liang Xinzhou was, but she also thanked him for the trending topic matter.

Liang Xinzhou: [Rest well and recover. I'll pick you up tonight.]

Liang Shi: [...]

Pick her up?

She could be discharged by herself.

Liang Shi replied that it wasn't necessary, but Liang Xinzhou didn't respond after that.

Soon someone came to clear away the table full of food. When Liang Shi checked the trending topics again, she found that the entries related to Dongheng Group had disappeared.

It had to be said, the power of capital was still strong.

This incident was as if it had never happened.

When the hospital room quieted down, Liang Shi opened a mini-program and played two rounds of games.

The little character in the game was treasure hunting, and Liang Shi casually tapped around as entertainment.

When her thoughts were completely relaxed, she finally opened that photo.

Taoyuan County, Taozhi Village, Guo Xinran.

Liang Shi searched for this name online and found that this girl was very good at utilizing the internet and media.

Her Weibo ID was [Family-Seeking Girl Guo Xinran], with seventy thousand followers.

Her bio read: All departed loved ones become stars watching over me, so I must live well.

She posted one Weibo post every day, with pictures of mountain scenery and her home.

Her home was dilapidated—once it rained, the ground would be full of mud.

There were two pigs and over ten chickens at home. The roof was covered with withered grass, and the long-unrepaired house looked like a dangerous building, to a degree unimaginable for people living in big cities.

Every Weibo post by Guo Xinran was very positive.

If she posted at night, she would write: Hope I can see my family in my dreams, good night everyone.

Occasionally when she had emotional breakdowns, she would post: Missing my grandmother.

Many people would comfort her below.

Liang Shi scrolled through all of her Weibo posts, from the day she registered her account until one day she posted: Rest in peace. /candle

From that day began her family-seeking journey.

Her pinned Weibo post was her self-introduction:

[My name is Guo Xinran, from Taozhi Village, Taoyuan County, Guangming Province. I'm 25 years old this year. Unfortunately, it was only on the day my grandmother passed away that I learned about my background—turns out I was bought by my adoptive parents.

That year, they were working in Haizhou City. Because my adoptive mother had just miscarried and was diagnosed as unable to conceive, and my adoptive father extremely loved children, they bought me from human traffickers when I was just a few months old. At that time I was just a baby and naturally knew nothing.

After buying me, my adoptive parents chose to return to Taozhi Village. I grew up here from childhood, thinking this was my home and these were my biological parents. But when I was seven, my adoptive mother became pregnant, and their attitude toward me changed. One day I heard them say they wanted to send me away because one family couldn't support two children. I was very scared and ran to my grandmother's house, also in the village.

My grandmother was disabled—at sixty-three, she broke her leg falling while picking mushrooms on the mountain. My grandfather had passed away in his fifties, so grandmother lived alone with great difficulty. Because my adoptive mother was pregnant, I didn't dare go back and could only live at grandmother's house, taking care of my disabled grandmother.

But that year, my unborn little sister died because of my adoptive mother's poor health, and my adoptive mother also passed away. My adoptive father never remarried but developed a drinking problem. He brought me back home, and every time he got drunk he would throw things and hit people. I was very scared, so I ran back to grandmother's house again.

Grandmother was very good to me, and my adoptive father gradually came to live with us too. He was still the same, but because grandmother was there, I rarely got beaten. As the only laborer in the family, my adoptive father would give me and grandmother living expenses every month, so I was fortunate enough to attend high school, but father was unwilling to pay for me to go to university.

My grades weren't good because my foundation was poor from childhood. Although I worked very hard in high school later, I still couldn't reach the undergraduate cutoff. Not going to university was regrettable, but I was also grateful that I could stay by grandmother's side to take care of her during those years.

Grandmother's disability became paralysis, and she could only lie in bed waiting for care. My adoptive father, due to alcoholism, fell down when drunk and hit his head on a stone, dying when I was 23. From then on, only grandmother and I were left to depend on each other.

I had also complained about life and fate, but I was grateful to still have grandmother with me. But I didn't expect that this year grandmother would also pass away. Before she died, she told me about my background and gave me the jewelry my biological parents had put on me. To this day, I no longer hold hope of finding my biological parents, but seeing the human trafficking case solved in Dongling City that day, hope ignited in my heart again.

Whether or not I can find my biological parents, whether my parents still remember me, I've tried my best.

As long as I try my best, I won't have regrets.

I hope this world can spare me a little love—just a little love would be enough.

Written to my biological parents: If you see my family-seeking information and don't want to acknowledge me, that's okay. Just send me a message to let me know I'm not alone in this world.

I've grown up now and can work hard to support myself. I will become a positive and upward person.

I won't pester you—don't be afraid. I hope you're living well.]

The accompanying photos showed her golden Pixiu<sup>1</sup> necklace and her selfie.

In the photo, she was smiling and looked very sunny.

The third photo showed the chickens she was raising—the chicken coop was messy, but the filter made it better highlight this person's kindness and diligence.



This Weibo post was nearly a thousand words long. Liang Shi read it from beginning to end three times, and no matter how she looked at it, it didn't seem like something written by someone who had only graduated high school with poor grades.

It wasn't that she was being conspiracy-minded, but having stayed in the entertainment industry too long, which celebrity's Weibo wasn't ghostwritten?

Especially such emotionally manipulative text was usually written by marketing experts hired at high prices.

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<sup>1</sup> Pixiu: A Chinese mythical creature, often used in jewelry and believed to bring wealth and ward off evil spirits

## Chapter 48-4

Liang Shi had previously seen a female celebrity who only graduated elementary school hire someone to ghostwrite an ornately worded sob story essay. There were also PR articles and statements from celebrity studios, all with dedicated ghostwriters.

The manipulative power of such writing need not be mentioned.

In this blog post, Guo Xinran was portrayed as a girl with a tragic background who was positive, optimistic, and understanding.

Especially at the end, what she said to her biological parents was practically stabbing at people's heartstrings.

Who wouldn't feel heartbroken for this girl after reading it?

If Liang Shi weren't standing on the opposing side looking at this today, she would definitely repost this Weibo to help her find her family, and might even donate money to her.

But Liang Shi was still rational at this moment. She searched for a lot of information online.

She discovered that Guo Xinran had posted family-seeking information on multiple platforms, skillfully exploiting people's empathy and the traffic algorithms of the internet age.

Calling her an internet celebrity, Liang Shi would believe it.

And now she also had the trend of becoming an internet celebrity—she had started filming some vlogs with some advertisements in them.

Some people raised questions, but were quickly refuted by her "fans," saying that now that she had lost her relatives, didn't she need to make money to support herself?

Based on her follower count across multiple platforms, her monthly income should be quite substantial now.

After all, being someone from the industry, Liang Shi would think about these issues from multiple angles.

From that blog post, she didn't quite believe the persona Guo Xinran had created for herself.

Too perfect.

That proved there must be flaws.

In everything, she was the victim.

But she was still living with hope, even having to comfort her "parents" in return.

This kind of persona, Liang Shi had only seen in TV dramas.

Logically speaking, with such a big commotion online, the Liang family should be able to see it.

Yet no one had contacted her.

Either no one knew the Liang family had lost a daughter, or the Liang family people didn't pay attention to this type of news, or the token she had wasn't something from the Liang family.

Although that golden Pixiu looked wealthy, the craftsmanship wasn't refined at all.

It didn't seem like a Liang family product.

Moreover, when Guo Xinran went missing, the Liang family business was still thriving.

Being in the luxury goods business, all the jewelry for newborns should be very "extravagant."

Just based on looks alone, it was too unconvincing.

If it weren't for Liang Shi knowing about this matter and being unusually sensitive to it, seeing at first glance that this girl resembled Qiu Zimin.

She also wouldn't suspect that the other party was Qiu Zimin's lost daughter.

Liang Shi used her alternate account to follow Guo Xinran, then sent her a private message: [Have you found your parents? Any leads?]

Guo Xinran's auto-reply was: [Thank you for following me. After I find my parents, I'll share the good news with everyone.]

So she hadn't found them yet.

Liang Shi also wanted to use this time to investigate the ritual matter. She vaguely felt that this mystical ritual event might be related to her transmigration, but it was just speculation.

After all, there was also the system involved.

She didn't know whether the system was more likely or the mystical event was more likely.

But with her arm injured, going to the old mansion tonight was once again out of the question.

## Chapter 48-5

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After spending a boring afternoon at the hospital, she organized Guo Xinran's information.

She didn't rule out the possibility that she really lived a hard life, but there was a 90% probability that this person was creating a persona, lying, and using this matter to make money.

Liang Shi made no judgment about this, nor did she have any misplaced kindness to tell the Liang family about this matter.

She just started preparing a backup plan for herself.

During this time, she had also accumulated some money from doing tasks, including her acting work. Although it was only two scenes, because it was emergency rescue work, she was paid ten thousand yuan, plus the pocket money Liang Xinhe had given her before, and what the original owner had left behind.

The original owner used to be someone who spent money like water, so there wasn't much balance in the account. When going out, she mostly used credit cards.

The original owner's credit cards were initially paid by Liang Xinzhou, but after being lectured several times, Qiu Zimin took over the payments.

Because Liang Shi hadn't followed Qiu Zimin's orders after transmigrating, Qiu Zimin hadn't paid her credit card bill this month.

The bill came to over seven hundred thousand yuan. Liang Shi took out all of the original owner's money to pay off the credit card, leaving only a little over nine thousand yuan.

...

After consolidating all her money, Liang Shi also looked at houses in Haizhou City.

The housing prices here were very high, generally over thirty thousand yuan per square meter, and that was in the suburbs.

With her current ability, buying a house was still impossible.

So after moving out of the villa, she would probably rent an apartment.

At times like this, Liang Shi inevitably began to miss the house she had bought in her original world.

Although the mortgage wasn't fully paid off, at least she had bought a large flat through her own efforts, and even found the design and decorated it herself. She had researched countless guides, and every corner of that house was in a style she loved.

But... she had only lived there for half a year!

Thinking about this, Liang Shi pressed her temples and tried to negotiate with the system, "Um, could you guys give me back my house?"

System: [?]

After a while, the system's eerie mechanical voice responded: [Sorry, host, what are you talking about? I don't understand.]

Liang Shi coughed lightly, feeling somewhat embarrassed, since negotiating about money wasn't her strong suit.

She used to have a "detached as a chrysanthemum" persona.

"I struggled for most of my life in that world and bought a house, over three million yuan, a large flat of more than one hundred square meters. There's only two hundred thousand left on the mortgage, which would be paid off soon. Could you guys bring my house from there over here?" To make her future life better, Liang Shi had thrown caution to the wind. "Look, I have no money here, no job, and can't go out. What am I supposed to live on? When the Liang family kicks me out later, wouldn't I have to sleep on the streets? That would be worse than just letting me go back."

She tried to reason with this cold system.

The system was silent for a few seconds, then said: [Sorry host, physical objects cannot be transferred between two spaces. The wealth you accumulated through hard work in the other world cannot be brought over, but you can obtain wealth prepared by the administration through completing tasks.]

Liang Shi: "...?"

"What about all my money?" Liang Shi exploded, "I worked hard and saved for the rest of my life, and you're saying you won't give it just like that?"

System: [Sorry host, you can obtain wealth prepared by the administration through completing tasks.]

This system might be a bit stupid.

The system that went to accept punishment last time hadn't returned yet, and this one was wooden and dull, only able to repeat this sentence.

Thinking about all her money, Liang Shi immediately became agitated.

"The wealth you guys prepared isn't even as much as I'd earn from filming one drama over there!" Liang Shi said, "I saved for so many years, reluctant to eat well or dress well, and you guys just made it disappear?"

System: [Sorry host...]

"Shut up!" Liang Shi was speechless, "I don't want to hear those four words. If you know you're sorry, then find a remedy."

The system fell silent.

Obviously, remedial measures weren't within the system's task scope.

Liang Shi: "..."

Her hard-working first half of life.

Gone without even a splash.

Liang Shi felt a bit emo.

When she first arrived, she hadn't realized money was so important.

However, the system wasn't completely beyond redemption—it issued Liang Shi another side quest.

...

[Ding dong! Based on host's needs, now issuing hidden task to host: Find Xu Qingzhu's biological parents.

Task duration: Thirty days. If thirty days are exceeded, the task automatically becomes invalid without deducting current luck points.

Task reward: One million yuan RMB. If completed within fifteen days, an additional two hundred thousand yuan reward. If you can reunite Xu Qingzhu with her family, an additional five hundred thousand yuan reward. Total task reward of one million seven hundred thousand yuan will be deposited into host's account on the day of task completion.

Host, keep it up! You're the best!

PS: This task's completion is based on Xu Qingzhu's recognition and must have a complete chain of evidence.

Additional PS: Xu Qingzhu is currently in good condition. If she reunites with her biological parents, there is a risk of triggering traumatic stress disorder. Please make your own choice, host.]

...

Hello?

Are you there?

Why don't you just send me back!

Liang Shi thought this system was sick.

Xu Qingzhu was doing fine with her parents now—why would you want to find her biological parents for her?

Although Liang Shi was also secretly searching, she wasn't forcing it!

Moreover, it was just her speculation, her wishful thinking.

Xu Qingzhu knew nothing about it!

And there was also the risk of triggering Xu Qingzhu's stress disorder.

She hadn't forgotten that when she first triggered Xu Qingzhu's stress disorder, her misfortune points increased by 4.

Although the misfortune point system was currently suspended for her, in thirty days, the misfortune point system would return!

This system was truly "fair."

Liang Shi cursed it eight hundred times in her heart.

However, because of this stupid system, her afternoon wasn't boring.

By evening, she asked Zhao Xuning to accompany her to handle the discharge procedures, but Zhao Xuning said the hospital staff wouldn't allow it.

A Liang family member had to come handle it.

Liang Shi: "..."

## Chapter 48-6

She waited until after seven o'clock before Liang Shi finally saw Liang Xinzhou and Liang Xinhe in the hospital room.

Both were not the type to say sweet words, just keeping straight faces while asking how she was doing.

She immediately answered: "All good."

After the attending physician's examination confirmed there were no issues, the two finally took Liang Shi out.

Liang Shi was nervous and had a bad premonition rising in her heart.

On the road, she asked: "Where are we going?"

"Home." Liang Xinzhou was reading the news and spared time to answer her, "The old mansion."

Liang Shi: "...?"

She didn't want to go back and face Qiu Zimin today!

Her combat effectiveness was weakened right now—what if something really happened?

Moreover, that room—whoever slept one night there would either die or be scared crazy.

Liang Shi firmly refused, "I want to go back to the villa. Xu Qingzhu will take care of me, so you can rest assured."

"Didn't you want to go back to the old mansion?" Liang Xinzhou put away his tablet and looked at her intently, "Besides, there's a family doctor at the old mansion who can monitor your condition at all times, and there are many servants who can ensure you have three meals a day with stable nutrition. I heard from your butler that you never have the servants cook. The servants in that building are mostly idle positions. Since that's the case, why not live at the old mansion?"

"You can squeeze into your room for tonight first, and tomorrow we'll clear out the third floor."

Liang Xinhe said, "If you're worried about Xu Qingzhu, don't worry. I've already spoken with her, and she's going back tonight too."

Liang Shi: "..."

Life was so hopeless.

"Once your injury heals, you can move back to your place." Seeing she was really unhappy, Liang Xinzhou said, "Father and Mother haven't seen you for a long time either. Don't be so willful when you're this grown up. You're already married, and in a few years you'll have children—how can you still not grow up?"

Liang Shi: "..."



Headache.

Did she also have to make Xu Qingzhu sleep in that coffin room with her?

They would both go crazy.

Liang Shi pressed her temples and tried to gently remind her two brothers, "Have you been in my room? That room's layout is too poor, I don't like it. Going back there is too stuffy—I want to go back to Shallow Water Bay."

Shallow Water Bay was the villa where she currently lived.

"I went in today." Liang Xinzhou said, "I went back at noon and your room layout is fine. It has windows and a balcony, and the walk-in closet is connected too. You've lived there for so many years—now you're saying it's poor?"

Liang Shi: "...!"

Liang Shi was astonished, her voice suddenly rising, "You went in?"

"Yeah." Liang Xinzhou said, "You were so strange this morning, so when I went back at noon to get documents, I naturally went in to take a look."

"Mom let you in?" Liang Shi's heart was beyond what shock could describe, and she asked repeatedly, "Was it my original room?"

She reasonably suspected that to deceive Liang Xinzhou, Qiu Zimin had changed her room.

But Liang Xinzhou said, "Yes, just turn left on the second floor."

Liang Shi: "..."

This was impossible.

But having said this much, if Liang Shi continued to refuse, she might get lectured again, so she reluctantly agreed.

But in her heart, she kept guessing—could it be that Liang Xinzhou had always known she lived in that room?

Or did that room have some mechanism that could quickly transform?

This was too suspicious!

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With an uneasy heart, Liang Shi returned home with her two brothers.

As soon as the car stopped and Liang Shi's feet touched the ground, Ling Dang ran over and hugged her legs, "Auntie!"

Liang Shi responded with a sound, and if it were normal times, she would have picked up Ling Dang long ago. But now with her arm injured, she couldn't lift her, so she could only squat down and rub her head, asking gently, "Have you been good lately?"

"I've been very good." Ling Dang said proudly, "Auntie, are you moving back home? And Aunt-in-law is coming too."

"Yes." Liang Shi said, "Aunt-in-law hasn't gotten off work yet. She'll come over after work."

"Aunt-in-law is so pitiful, still having to work overtime." Ling Dang sighed with adult-like intonation, making Liang Shi laugh.

She used her uninjured hand to hold Ling Dang's as they walked toward the house.

Liang Father wasn't there—he had gone on a business trip.

Qiu Zimin was sitting on the living room sofa. When she saw her come in, she immediately showed concern: "How could you be so careless? Isn't your big brother more capable than you? What were you trying to prove? If something really happened to you, how would I go on living?"

Liang Shi: "..."

She thought to herself: if something really happened, you'd probably laugh toward the sky for three minutes first.

You'd be so happy.

However, Liang Shi knew she was putting on an act in front of everyone, so she didn't expose her.

She just couldn't be bothered to cooperate with her performance.

"Let Mom take a look." Qiu Zimin looked at her with concern, tears in her eyes, appearing to be a completely different person from when she had threatened her privately, "Don't run around during this time, stay home and rest well. Your health is most important."

"I have to work." Liang Shi broke free from her embrace, her tone cold—completely unlike how she treated the Liang brothers. Anyone could hear her distance and indifference, "Work isn't running around."

Qiu Zimin was stunned, "Then let your second brother drive you every day."

With Liang Shi's arm injured, she couldn't drive. Since she was staying at the old mansion, having Liang Xinhe drive her was reasonable.

She agreed to this proposal.

Normally at this time, the Liang family would have dinner.

Even Ling Dang was saying she was hungry, but everyone was still waiting for Xu Qingzhu.

Liang Shi told everyone not to wait and to eat first.

As for Xu Qingzhu's meal, they could save her a separate portion—she might have already eaten at the company.

At first, everyone disagreed. After all, Xu Qingzhu didn't come often, and all in all, she had only been here twice.

But Liang Shi insisted, so everyone listened to her.

## Chapter 48-7

The atmosphere at the Liang family dining table was always oppressive, with no one talking.

On the large table sat delicious dishes, but Liang Shi had no appetite, just picking at the two vegetable dishes in front of her with her chopsticks.

While she was eating and thinking, a bowl of soup appeared in front of her.

She looked up and found it was Liang Xinzhou's wife, Yu Wan.

Yu Wan was a rather cold person, not as gentle as Sun Meirou. She also didn't have a good impression of her sister-in-law Liang Shi, and had never said a word to her during Liang Shi's previous visits.

Now she was actually taking the initiative to serve her soup?

Yu Wan wasn't good with words either, similar to Liang Xinzhou. After placing the soup in front of Liang Shi, she continued eating.

Liang Shi: "..."

She said gently, "Thank you, sister-in-law."

Qiu Zimin also reminded her several times to eat more.

But her attitude was always cold and indifferent, hardly good.

Anyone with eyes could see this, so Liang Xinhe had Sun Meirou try to get information from her, asking if she had quarreled with Qiu Zimin.

She just brushed it off evasively.

After dinner, Ling Dang had to do homework.

Liang Shi sat in the living room to accompany her.

Yu Wan's situation was different from Sun Meirou's.

Yu Wan was an only child, so even after marriage she continued working at her family's company. With high work pressure, she had never had children.

But from their conversations, she was also preparing for pregnancy recently.

After all, Yu Wan was getting older.

Although technology in this world was very advanced, it was still not very friendly to older mothers.

However, the mortality rate for older mothers had decreased significantly.

As someone who had never been exposed to the ABO world before, Liang Shi had also quietly researched the information. Female Alphas could make Omegas pregnant through special positions after marking them.

Of course, there were also special medications that could help increase an Omega's chances of pregnancy.

Regular intercourse could also make Omegas pregnant, but the probability was extremely small.

The pregnancy probability right after marking was twice that of regular intercourse.

Combined with human rights laws and the continuous decline in population growth rates, the country didn't allow abortions.

So no hospital could schedule abortion procedures.

Even contraceptives were only distributed to people under 25, with restrictions on purchases through personal ID verification.

Someone like Yu Wan was truly an exception in this world.

However, Yu Wan had physical damage in her early years, making it difficult for her to conceive.

She was now taking medicine to regulate her condition.

To encourage everyone to have children, a series of policies encouraging childbirth had been introduced.

But these were all friendly to the lower classes. For families like the Liang family, they basically didn't care and just went by personal preference.

After researching this, Liang Shi was shocked and even secretly looked up that special position. Indeed.

Rather embarrassing, and quite physically demanding.

But when emotions reached their peak, that method would bring people ultimate release.

Anyway, from the educational videos, both people looked very comfortable.

Their expressions were more pleasant than in other videos.

They could even become infatuated with and fall in love with each other through that method.

If the Alpha's technique was good enough.

After all, Liang Shi saw in one video that the Omega initially had no particular feelings for the Alpha—it was just normal work completion. But after one time, her eyes changed.

Then the Alpha had a second time, a third time.

In the end, the Omega would nuzzle against the Alpha, even obsessively licking her glands.

That time opened the door to a new world for Liang Shi.

However, she had only watched it that once.

She didn't dare to indulge afterward.

She was genuinely curious about ABO body structure and mating methods.

She just... couldn't suppress her curiosity.

Later, after discovering she would have needs, she rarely watched anymore.

She forced herself to abstain from desires.

## Chapter 48-8

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After Liang Shi finished helping Ling Dang with homework, she played games with her for a while.

By after nine o'clock, the little one was drowsy and soon fell asleep in Liang Shi's arms.

Later, Liang Xinhe carried her back to her room.

Since returning, Liang Shi had never gone to look at her own room.

She had already decided that when Xu Qingzhu came over, if they went upstairs and it was still that coffin room, she would have Xu Qingzhu scream frantically, wake up everyone in the villa, then question Qiu Zimin together.

At that time, she would definitely play the most innocent one.

Then leave that place with Xu Qingzhu.

Directly lay everything out in the open.

She still had confidence in Liang Xinhe.

At least Ling Dang genuinely liked and depended on her, so if Liang Xinhe knew about those things in that room and still let Ling Dang play with her, that would mean Liang Xinhe was also a major pervert.

If she was really this unlucky after coming here, then she would accept it.

Consider her blind.

But Liang Shi's years of social luck gave her confidence in this matter.

So she kept waiting downstairs. When Liang Xinhe came down after putting Ling Dang to bed, he asked her, "Sister-in-law hasn't come back yet? Did she forget she was supposed to come back here?"

"She went back to her home." Liang Shi said, "Her father has a bit of a fever, so she went back to check on him. She'll come back later—I'll wait for her a bit."

Liang Xinhe frowned, "Alright."

From his expression, he clearly had something to say but was holding back.

But Liang Shi didn't plan to ask. She had already guessed what Liang Xinhe wanted to ask.

After a while, Liang Xinhe couldn't help but ask, "Did you quarrel with Mom?"

Liang Shi shook her head, "No."

Just had many unpleasant incidents.

Liang Xinhe frowned, "Then your attitude toward Mom is too abnormal. Didn't you used to treat Mom the best? Mom cares about you, but you don't give her a good face. In front of your sister-in-laws, how does this make Mom feel?"

Liang Shi pressed her temples, "But you should also ask what Mom did."

Liang Xinhe wasn't blindly filial either, and asked her, "What? Did she cancel your credit card?"

"No." Liang Shi said, "Money matters are all small things. I don't spend much now anyway."

"Then what is it?" Liang Xinhe pressed.

Liang Shi thought for a few seconds, "I can't say right now, but you can go ask her. I think she won't tell you either."

"Are you playing riddles with me?" Liang Xinhe paused, then said earnestly, "Mom isn't young anymore, and you're the one she loves most. Don't be foolish—if you make Mom angry, I won't spare you. If it's about money, there's no need. Just tell me and big brother—we have money. But don't take money and go do those things you used to do. If I find out, I'll still cancel your cards."

Liang Xinhe said this while stuffing a black gold credit card into her hands.

This type of card had limits starting from one million.

But Liang Shi didn't take it. She said sincerely, "Second brother, it's really not about money. I have hands and feet—I can make money. The conflict between her and me isn't something that can be explained in a few words, but someday you'll know. Just don't worry about it for now and go back to your room to sleep."

Liang Xinhe wanted to ask more, but Liang Shi stuffed a throw pillow into her arms and lowered her head, burying her face in it, "Either go ask her, or go back to sleep. Anyway, I'm not saying."

With a hint of acting spoiled.

Liang Xinhe had no way to deal with her, finally saying helplessly, "Anyway, don't be foolish. If Mom did something wrong, I'll make her apologize to you."

Liang Shi thought to herself that some things couldn't be resolved with just an apology.

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The living room quieted down. Most of the servants had returned to their own quarters, leaving only two in case of emergencies.

Liang Shi looked at her phone—it was already ten o'clock.



She was about to send a message asking Xu Qingzhu if she was still coming back when she had just typed the message but hadn't sent it yet, and a servant's voice came from the entrance: "Third Madam."

In some aspects, the Liang family's rules were very strict.

This was reflected in dining etiquette and servant protocols.

Liang Shi got up to greet her, inquiring about Xu Guangyao's health.

Xu Qingzhu looked tired but still answered her questions in a low voice, even coming close to carefully examine her wound.

Liang Shi hurriedly said, "I'm really fine, it doesn't hurt anymore."

Only after Xu Qingzhu had looked did she say, "You said you were fine at noon too."

Liang Shi: "..."

Thinking of the afternoon's crash scene, Liang Shi's expression was poor, but she immediately changed the topic, asking if she had eaten.

Xu Qingzhu nodded, "I have."

After saying this, she asked where the room was, with the air of someone ready for a big fight.

Full of fighting spirit.

Liang Shi had already sent her a message beforehand, since Xu Qingzhu was also one of the only two witnesses to the photo.

So Xu Qingzhu was now still carrying a hint of excitement, very much like someone coming to cause trouble.

Liang Shi said, "Second floor, turn left."

But she couldn't bear to see her looking so tired yet still having to do this, so she said, "Should we go back to Shallow Water Bay first?"

"We're already here." Xu Qingzhu said, "Can we do nothing? Besides, if we leave now, we'll be lectured to death later."

Liang Shi: "...It should be fine, I'll talk to big brother and second brother."

Xu Qingzhu gave a light snort, "You're their sister, but I'm not. The one who gets squeezed out will definitely be me."

Liang Shi: "..."

That made sense too.

So the two went upstairs together. Liang Shi entered the password and unlocked the door, but didn't push it open. She first let Xu Qingzhu prepare herself mentally.

After all, last time she had pushed it open unexpectedly and got quite a fright.

Xu Qingzhu smiled, exhaustion mixed with a few traces of laziness. Her hair fell over her shoulders, and the corner of her lips curved up in an alluring arc, "I've seen it before—just open it."

Liang Shi was still worried, "Can you act it out?"

Xu Qingzhu: "..."

Xu Qingzhu was indeed tired after a long day and didn't want to waste time.

She found Liang Shi too wordy right now, so she directly put her hand on Liang Shi's hand and pushed the door open in one motion.

Xu Qingzhu was about to scream, but just as a little sound came out, sharp-eyed Liang Shi noticed something was wrong and immediately covered her mouth from behind. Xu Qingzhu was covered so tightly she could barely breathe and kicked Liang Shi's calf.

Only then did Liang Shi ease up a little, but didn't completely let go.

The two maintained this position as they entered the room.

This room was completely different from the one Liang Shi had come to before.

## Chapter 48-9

The room's main color scheme was sky blue, paired with a touch of minimalist gray. The door that had been locked on the other side was now connected, turning into a walk-in closet. The windows were light green with small floral patterns, looking very fresh and clean.

Xu Qingzhu turned around in bewilderment, and her head happened to bump into Liang Shi's chin.

Liang Shi winced and sucked in a sharp breath from the pain.

The room door was closed. At this moment, Liang Shi was rapidly processing information, not even caring about the pain.

When did Qiu Zimin change this room?

Could she really renovate without alerting anyone during the renovation?

Liang Xinzhou said he hadn't entered this room since she was sixteen, and the next time he entered was today.

He was an action-oriented person who would investigate when he noticed something was wrong.

So the original owner had never revealed information about her room to everyone before.

Maybe she had resisted but was persuaded by Qiu Zimin.

From when Liang Shi returned last time until today, it had been less than half a month, yet Qiu Zimin had changed this room's decoration style without anyone knowing.

She really suspected this room had some mechanism, like a one-button transformation.

But she scanned every corner of the room and found nothing abnormal.

Xu Qingzhu kicked her again, and only then did she realize she had been too absorbed in observing the room and forgot to let go of the hand covering Xu Qingzhu's mouth.

She immediately withdrew it and apologized sheepishly, "Sorry."

Xu Qingzhu's lips had been rubbed red by her hand, and under the warm yellow light of the room, they appeared rippling and lustrous.

"Are you sure it was still the decoration from the photo when you came back last time?" Xu Qingzhu didn't mind her rude behavior and instead looked around the room.

Liang Shi nodded, "Yes."

"This room has the smell of new renovation, but it's not strong." Xu Qingzhu said, "You can't tell without carefully smelling. The air is mostly filled with a very light perfume scent—freesia fragrance. But neither you nor I use this perfume. Your mother habitually uses BARE products, but BARE products don't have freesia scent."

Xu Qingzhu understood this world better and quickly analyzed a lead. Then she walked to the wall and moved the bedroom wardrobe. Her fingers reached into the gap and felt that it was newly pasted wallpaper.

"Did you have a walk-in closet when you came last time?" Xu Qingzhu walked into the walk-in closet.

Liang Shi shook her head, "No, this space was sealed off."

After measuring every area with her feet, Xu Qingzhu reached her conclusion, "This house has been renovated."

"I think so too." Liang Shi said.

During the observation process just now, Liang Shi had also figured it out.

Everything she had seen before was mostly due to lighting and windows—a world without light would create a terrifying atmosphere.

Renovating a room like this wouldn't take three days.

With the Liang family's financial resources, it could probably be completed in one day.

So Qiu Zimin had planned ahead. After discovering her personality had changed, she directly changed the room.

This showed she was also afraid of her two sons finding out.

What about Liang Father?

What role did he play in all this?

Did he know about the ritual matter?

Liang Shi was more inclined to guess that he knew.

After looking around, Xu Qingzhu sighed, "Worthy of being Mrs. Liang."

Liang Shi smiled helplessly, "Indeed very capable."

Xu Qingzhu was tired after a long day. Now back in a space that belonged to just the two of them, she could finally rest. She sat on the bed and couldn't help lying down.

The soft bed induced drowsiness. Her hair spread like seaweed on the light pink double bed, and those clear eyes carried heavy fatigue.

But after her eyes rolled around a few times, she looked toward Liang Shi. She had originally wanted to share her new speculation with her, but when she saw Liang Shi's shoulder bleeding through the bandage, her expression changed and she immediately said sternly, "Come here."

Liang Shi: "...?"

At this moment, Xu Qingzhu sat up, staring straight at Liang Shi.

Liang Shi sensed danger, "What for?"

Xu Qingzhu said, "Come here."

Liang Shi protested verbally but shuffled over with her feet. But as soon as she stood over, Xu Qingzhu pulled her down, and she sat directly on the bed.

Her center of gravity was unstable, and her whole body fell backward.

The moment she fell on the bed, Xu Qingzhu's body also uncontrollably pressed over.

Liang Shi's mind immediately flashed with the educational videos she had watched before, but she didn't dare have any improper thoughts about Xu Qingzhu.

She bit her lip, swallowed some saliva, and stammered, "I... I can't."

Xu Qingzhu: "?"

Liang Shi gave up completely, "I really can't, you... don't..."

Xu Qingzhu stared at her, looking at her frightened expression, combined with these words.

...

Xu Qingzhu suddenly leaned close to her, her fingers pressing on her gland location, making Liang Shi's entire body tremble.

Her lips quivered, "Don't... don't..."

Xu Qingzhu leaned closer, their eyes meeting.

Her cool voice was lingering and entangling, all the hot breath spilling onto her lips, "Are you unable to do it on top, or unable to do it on bottom?"

Liang Shi: "..."

Xu Qingzhu moved even closer, her fingers lightly pressing on the glands at the back of Liang Shi's neck, her voice becoming more alluring, her leg also pressing against Liang Shi's leg, even somewhat forcefully separating them.

"Are you unable with your hands, or unable with your mouth?"

Liang Shi: "!!!"